

Outlook Automation Project

Request

"I own a business, and I want to automate emails to be sent from one of my Outlook business email addresses. I have a list of potential customers, and I'd like to have emails sent out regularly. I want the automation to pull the name from a csv document as well as the email addresses. I have a few different lists, so I'd have a different "script/email" for each of the 3-4 different lists. I'd like to have a certain number sent a day (10? 25? 50?) at a set time (one every 5 min or so?)."

Requirements

The csv file contains all the client information. The key ones for the automation are:

- Email address
- First name of recipient
- Company name

Information to be regularly updated:

- Next scheduled email
- Date and Time of last sent email
- Track number of emails sent to each client over time
- Track number of responses from each client

Testing

- Have automated tests to ensure emails are generated with the correct name and information

Fail Cases:

- Unsubscribe handling required
- Bounce handling and flagging in csv

This updated information will be stored in a csv with backups generated every start of the month. Previous csv also saved.

CSV will be updated manually with new potential clients. Clients who become customers will be removed from the list manually.

Setup

- Need linkage to all outlook email addresses that will be sending out emails. This will require access to Microsoft admin account (temporary Guest Admin access possible)
- Shared storage such as One Drive which contains csv files that will be updated with new clients
- Logs need to be stored
- Templates stored in OneDrive and to be used to generate emails
- Hosting scheduled runs on GitHub actions

Workflow

1. Workflow begins at 9am MST, syncing to OneDrive
2. At the first of the month backup all csv files in a separate folder
3. Load CSVs, sort by next scheduled date and take entries with a scheduled date on or before present day (account for daily limit)
4. Create queue based on ordering, prepping email creation to begin 5 mins after previous email
5. Fetch the associated email template based on industry (assuming csv files are industry separated?)
6. If email is successfully created and sent, fill in last sent datetime and enter new next schedule date to be 21 days into the future. If failed, flag in separate log file and leave scheduled date unchanged.

Potential future updates

- Dashboard/report showing data collected such as response rate stratified by industry

Implementation Rollout

1. Core sending for one list, one account, manual CSV updates
2. Multi-list, multi-account support
3. Response tracking, bounce handling, unsubscribe link handling
4. Summary report/dashboard